Kurukshetra: A Life · Art still needed

27 new paintings for the parts of the game built this week · 31 October 2026 · Replaces the "still needed" lists in all earlier briefs.

Status. Everything ordered earlier is delivered and in the game, including the 31 October corrections. None of these 27 block a release: until a painting arrives, the game uses the stand-in shown on each card, which is there only to show the mood, not as a model to copy.

Rules for every image

- **No painted text:** no letters, numbers or captions in the picture.
- Keep the main subject in the centre (phones crop the sides) and the lower third calmer (text sits over it).
- **Period:** early historic India, with timber, brick and stone towns, toranas, courtyards and stupas. **Avoid** domes, Gothic spires, castle towers, later temple spires, East Asian roofs and gates, Greek columns and helmets, glass lanterns, and modern targets or pens.
- **Content:** no gore (violence implied only). Krishna and the gods are not shown as figures. Draupadi is never shown humiliated.
- **Delivery:** JPG under 1 MB (tall under 600 KB), the exact file names below, and a `manifest.csv`. Label AI-made or AI-edited work as before.

Kind	Files	Layout
Scene	1800×600 (3:1) and 2560×1440 `_wide`	A painting behind the story text.
Stage	2560×1440 and 1080×1920 `_tall`	A test is played over it: keep the middle and lower band open, without large figures.
Fight	2560×1440 and 1080×1920 `_tall`	Level, open ground across the lower band where the fighters stand; state the ground line's height, as before.

Divine weapons and magic (11)

Act V quests: a sage, a fire, a lake or a mountain grants a named weapon. These are the grounds the tests are played on, and the scenes around them.



In the game now:

`stage_forest_clearing_night`

1. `stage_fire_altar`

Stage

In the game: The Agneyastra quest

A fire altar in a forest clearing at night: a square brick altar with a tall fire, a ring of trees lit orange, sparks rising. The test is played in front of it.

2560×1440 (16:9) and 1080×1920 `_tall`



In the game now:

`stage_forest_lake`

2. `stage_deep_lake`

Stage

In the game: The Varunastra quest: the dive

A deep, clear mountain lake seen half above and half below the surface. Light shafts in the water, weed, and a small bronze vessel resting on the stony bottom.

2560×1440 (16:9) and 1080×1920 `_tall`



In the game now:

`stage_forest_edge`

3. `stage_mountain_path`

Stage

In the game: The climb to the hermitage

A steep Himalayan path with snow, ice and loose stone, prayer cairns, and a tiny hermitage far above in the clouds. Climbed on foot.

2560×1440 (16:9) and 1080×1920 `_tall`



In the game now:

`stage_forest_clearing_night`

4. `stage_gandharva_grove`

Stage

In the game: Sparing the Gandharva

A moonlit grove with mist, flowering trees and fallen petals. The Gandharva is only a soft glow between the trees: no figure.

2560×1440 (16:9) and 1080×1920 `_tall`



In the game now:

`stage_healers_hall`

5. `stage_naga_bank`

Stage

In the game: The Nagapasha quest

A reedy riverbank at dusk, with carved serpent stones (naga stones) half in the water and offerings of flowers on them.

2560×1440 (16:9) and 1080×1920 `_tall`



In the game now:

`stage_forest_edge`

6. `stage_shiva_mountain`

Stage

In the game: Shiva's mountain

A high, bare mountain top at dawn, wind tearing at the snow, and a great light breaking in the clouds. No figure of the god: light and wind only.

2560×1440 (16:9) and 1080×1920 `_tall`



In the game now:

`stage_palace_corridor`

7. `scene_temple_offering` Scene

In the game: The stolen temple lamp

A small temple's inner shrine at night: stone walls, flowers, smoke, and a bronze lamp burning on the altar that the player may take.

1800×600 (3:1) and 2560×1440 (16:9) `_wide`



In the game now:

`scene_ashram`

8. `scene_sage_year` Scene

In the game: A year with a sage

Life in a forest ashram over a year: the player sweeping the yard, fetching water, studying palm leaves beside an old sage.

1800×600 (3:1) and 2560×1440 (16:9) `_wide`



In the game now:

`scene_raid`

9. `scene_brahmastra` Scene

In the game: “The mantra no one should hold”

A scroll lying in the dark, faintly glowing, and a hand stopping short of it. Ominous and quiet.

1800×600 (3:1) and 2560×1440 (16:9) `_wide`



In the game now:

`war_eve`

10. `scene_raksha_sutra` Scene

In the game: “The night before”

The night before the war: lamps in the tents, and a sacred red thread being tied on a warrior's wrist by someone who loves them.

1800×600 (3:1) and 2560×1440 (16:9) `_wide`



In the game now:

`scene_rajasuya`

11. `scene_soma` Scene

In the game: “The pressing of the Soma”

The Soma rite at the Rajasuya: priests pressing the plant between stones beside the fire, and a cup handed to the player.

1800×600 (3:1) and 2560×1440 (16:9) `_wide`

Episodes and threads (15)

Story threads across a life (Ugra, the mentors, a sibling on the other side) and episodes in exile, the war and after.



In the game now:

`scene_tournament`

12. `scene_tournament_crowd` Scene

In the game: “The morning before the princes' tournament”

Crowds filling the wooden stands of the arena at sunrise, banners going up, vendors and children.

1800×600 (3:1) and 2560×1440 (16:9) `_wide`



In the game now:
`scene_note`

13. `scene_ugra_letter` Scene

In the game: “A letter in a miller's hand”

A letter on palm leaf in rough writing, read by lamplight on a mud floor.

1800×600 (3:1) and 2560×1440 (16:9) `_wide`



In the game now:
`war_day17`

14. `scene_ugra_field` Scene

In the game: “The miller's son, with a captain's spear”

Ugra, the miller's son from the player's childhood, now a grown captain with a spear, across the battlefield on the other side.

1800×600 (3:1) and 2560×1440 (16:9) `_wide`



In the game now:
`scene_secret`

15. `scene_secret_told` Scene

In the game: “A thing known for twenty-seven years”

Two figures in a quiet lamplit room, one telling the other a long-kept secret. Seen partly from behind.

1800×600 (3:1) and 2560×1440 (16:9) `_wide`



In the game now:
`scene_indraprastha`

16. `scene_mentor_vidura` Scene

In the game: “A lamp, a table, a question”

Vidura at a low table with one lamp, asking the player a question across it.

1800×600 (3:1) and 2560×1440 (16:9) `_wide`



In the game now:
`scene_dice_hall`

17. `scene_mentor_kripa` Scene

In the game: “Before the dice are thrown”

Kripa taking the player aside in a palace corridor while the court gathers for the dice game.

1800×600 (3:1) and 2560×1440 (16:9) `_wide`



In the game now:
`scene_ashram`

18. `scene_mentor_peace` Scene

In the game: “A teacher's last asking”

An old teacher in a simple hut asking one last thing of the player.

1800×600 (3:1) and 2560×1440 (16:9) `_wide`



In the game now:
`scene_lake`

19. `scene_lake_charu` Scene

In the game: “Charu, face down at the water's edge”

The Yaksha's lake with Charu, the player's friend, lying at the water's edge. Fallen, not hurt-looking.

1800×600 (3:1) and 2560×1440 (16:9) `_wide`



In the game now:

`fight_war_camp`

20. `fight_supply_carts`

Fight

In the game: “The camp wakes”

Grain carts and watch-fires in an army camp at night, the camp waking to a raid. Level, open ground for the fight.

2560×1440 (16:9) and 1080×1920 `_tall`



In the game now:

`war_bhishma`

21. `scene_shikhandi`

Scene

In the game: “Shikhandi at the front of the chariot”

Shikhandi at the front of a chariot on the tenth day, with Bhishma lowering his bow in the distance.

1800×600 (3:1) and 2560×1440 (16:9) `_wide`



In the game now:

`scene_vasu`

22. `scene_letter_camp`

Scene

In the game: “A letter carried under a truce flag”

A rider crossing between the armies at dusk under a white truce flag, carrying a letter.

1800×600 (3:1) and 2560×1440 (16:9) `_wide`



In the game now:

`war_day17`

23. `scene_sibling_field`

Scene

In the game: “A face you know, across a spear's length”

An elder brother or sister facing the player across a spear's length on the field, from the enemy side.

1800×600 (3:1) and 2560×1440 (16:9) `_wide`



In the game now:

`scene_forgiveness`

24. `scene_river_rite`

Scene

In the game: “Lamps on the water for the dead”

After the war: many people setting lamps on the river at dusk for the dead.

1800×600 (3:1) and 2560×1440 (16:9) `_wide`



In the game now:

`scene_student`

25. `scene_own_student`

Scene

In the game: “A child with a stick, waiting at your door”

Years later, a child with a stick for a bow waiting at the older player's door at morning.

1800×600 (3:1) and 2560×1440 (16:9) `_wide`



In the game now:

`end_teller`

26. `scene_bard`

Scene

In the game: “A bard sings the war, and gets it wrong”

A bard singing the war to a village crowd under a tree, while an old warrior listens at the back.

1800×600 (3:1) and 2560×1440 (16:9) `_wide`

Command (1)

Rising to command a company in the war.



In the game now:

`war_capture`

27. `scene_line_broken`

Scene

In the game: “The line, after”

After a lost holding fight: a broken company line, a fallen banner, survivors regrouping in the dust.

1800×600 (3:1) and 2560×1440 (16:9) `_wide`